

Shingles Vaccine

Vaccination safety requirements

The signed PGD behind this page is unaltered. This correction takes precedence over it.

What is missing from the signed document

- No requirement for adrenaline, and no anaphylaxis provision of any kind.
- No observation period after vaccination.
- No cold chain excursion procedure.
- No sharps disposal provision.

What must be in place before you vaccinate under this PGD

- Adrenaline (epinephrine) 1 in 1,000 injection must be immediately available in the room where vaccination takes place, in date, together with a telephone.
- A written anaphylaxis protocol consistent with current Resuscitation Council UK guidance must be available, and every person administering must be trained in the recognition and immediate management of anaphylaxis and hold current basic life support training.
- Observe every patient for 15 minutes after vaccination. Vaccinate seated, and have procedures in place to prevent injury from a faint.
- Record the batch number and the anatomical site for every dose given. A recall cannot be actioned without the batch number.

If these are not in place

Do not vaccinate under this PGD. This is not a documentation point: anaphylaxis after vaccination is rare, and it is the thing that kills. The requirement exists so that the one time it happens, the adrenaline is in the room.

Why this notice exists

A review of every vaccination PGD on the platform on 8 September 2026 found that these requirements were stated in some signed documents and not others. Where they were absent, nothing in the signed document required adrenaline to be present. Pharmacies almost certainly have it and are trained; the problem is that the document did not require it, so it was not evidenced anywhere if anyone asked.

A corrected version of this PGD will be issued and will carry these requirements in the body of the document. Until then, this notice applies.

This Patient Group Direction (PGD) is intended only for registered healthcare professionals who have been named and authorised by their organisation to practice under it.

Patient Group Direction
for the administration of Shingrix for the prevention of Shingles

Summary of NICE and NICE CKS Guidelines for Shingles Vaccination

Purpose of Vaccination

- To **prevent shingles (herpes zoster)** and its complications, particularly **postherpetic neuralgia (PHN)**.
- Risk of shingles increases with **age** and **weakened immunity**.

Vaccines Available

There are **two shingles vaccines** currently in use in the UK:

1. **Shingrix® (recombinant, non-live)**
 - **Preferred vaccine**, especially for immunocompromised individuals.
 - Suitable for people **aged 50 years and older** or **18+ if immunocompromised**.
 - Administered **intramuscularly**.
2. **Zostavax® (live attenuated)**
 - Only used **if Shingrix is contraindicated or unavailable**.
 - Not recommended for immunocompromised individuals.
 - Single **subcutaneous** dose for **those aged 70–79 years** (if previously eligible and missed).

Eligibility (UK Immunisation Schedule)

- **Routine vaccination:**
 - All individuals **aged 65 years**, starting from 1 September 2023.
 - A **catch-up programme** includes those turning 66 to 70 years between 1 September 2023 and 31 August 2028.
- **Immunocompromised individuals:**
 - Aged **18 years and over** are eligible for **Shingrix®**.
 - Includes those with conditions such as leukaemia, HIV, or on immunosuppressive therapy.
- **Unvaccinated individuals aged 70–79** remain eligible under the original **Zostavax®** programme if not contraindicated.

Dosing Schedules

- **Shingrix®:**
 - **Two doses** given **2 to 6 months apart**.
- **Zostavax®:**
 - **Single dose only**.

Contraindications

- **Shingrix:**
 - Hypersensitivity to any component.
- **Zostavax (live vaccine):**
 - Immunosuppressed individuals.
 - Pregnancy (defer until after delivery).
 - Hypersensitivity to gelatin or neomycin (if present in the formulation).

Precautions

- Delay vaccination in cases of acute illness with fever.
- Not for treatment of acute shingles.
- Check vaccine history prior to administration.

Common Side Effects

- **Shingrix:** Localised pain, fatigue, headache, myalgia, fever.
- **Zostavax:** Injection site reactions, mild rash, headache.

Effectiveness

- **Shingrix:** Over **90% effective** at preventing shingles and PHN.
- **Zostavax:** Around **50–60% effective**, lower efficacy in older adults.

Documentation

- Record date, site, batch number, and brand of vaccine.
- Report any suspected adverse reactions to the **Yellow Card Scheme**.

Patient Group Direction

for the supply/administration of

Shingrix

for vaccination against

Shingles

Healthcare professionals covered and training

	Healthcare professionals allowed to work under this PGD and requirements
Qualifications and Registration	● Pharmacist registered and practicing with the GPhC ● Pharmacy technician registered and practicing with the GPhC
Training and assessment	● Pharmacists and Pharmacy Technicians must have completed training relevant to this condition to use this PGD. This training will be documented and overseen by the Get Real Health team. ● All users must be familiar with the SPC for the products as well as BNF advice and any applicable national guidelines ● All users must previously have used PGD's to supply medication ● Must work in compliance with the SOPs of their own employer ● All users must have appropriate indemnity in place to cover this service
Further training and responsibilities	● All users must be up to date with CPD requirements and appraisal ● All users must be up to date with MHRA and safety alerts with regards to medical products ● All users must understand the concepts of capacity and consent and be aware of the Mental Capacity Act 2005.

PGD Indication	Shingrix is indicated for the prevention of herpes zoster (shingles) and herpes zoster-related postherpetic neuralgia in individuals aged 50 years and older.
Inclusion criteria	- Individuals aged 50 years or older. - No previous shingles vaccination. - No history of shingles in the past 12 months. - Informed consent obtained. - Patient is eligible under national immunisation guidelines.
Exclusion criteria	Hypersensitivity to any component of the vaccine. Pregnancy or breastfeeding (not routinely recommended).
Cautions	Counsel patient that systemic side effects are common and generally self-limiting. Allow appropriate spacing from other vaccines (e.g., COVID-19 or influenza) based on clinical judgement.
Actions if patient is excluded or declines treatment	Advise on alternative treatment options and how these can be accessed. Document any advice given and the decision reached. Inform or refer to the GP as appropriate

Details of the medicine

Name, form and strength of medicine	Shingrix
Legal category	POM
Storage	Store in a refrigerator (2°C–8°C). Do not freeze. Protect from light.
Route/method of administration	Intramuscular injection, preferably in the deltoid muscle.
Dose and frequency	0.5 mL dose given twice, with the second dose 2 to 6 months after the first.
Quantity to be administered and/or supplied	0.5 mL per dose; two-dose course required
Maximum or minimum treatment period	Two doses required, spaced 2–6 months apart.
Adverse effects	Localised pain, redness, swelling at injection site, fatigue, headache, myalgia, shivering, fever, gastrointestinal symptoms. Refer to SmPC for full details.

Yellow card reporting	Report suspected adverse effects via https://yellowcard.mhra.gov.uk and inform the GP as appropriate.
Records to be kept	Record the following information: ● that valid informed consent was given ● name of individual, address, date of birth and GP ● name of healthcare practitioner ● name and brand of medication ● date of supply dose, form and route quantity supplied ● advice given, including advice given if excluded or declines treatment ● details of any adverse drug reactions and actions taken supplied via PGD Records should be signed and dated. All records should be clear, legible and contemporaneous. Electronic records can be made. A record of all individuals receiving treatment under this PGD should also be kept for audit purposes as follows: ● Adults aged 18 years and over - keep records for 8 years ● Children aged under 18 years -keep records until the 25th birthday (if the patient was 17 years when treatment was finished, keep records until the 26th birthday)

Patient information

Written information to be given to patient or carer	Supply the patient information leaflet (PIL) provided with the medication.
Follow-up advice to be given to patient or carer	To seek medical advice if symptoms worsen rapidly or significantly, do not improve in 3–4 weeks, or they become systemically very unwell.

Key references

- NICE Medicines Practice Guideline 2 (MPG2): Patient Group Directions. Published March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2>
- NICE MPG2 Patient group directions: competency framework for health professionals using patient group directions. Updated March 2017 <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/mpg2/resources>
- NICE CKS Guidance
- British National Formulary (BNF) Key information on the selection, prescribing, dispensing and administration of medicines [BNF \(British National Formulary\) | NICE](#)
- Summary of Product Characteristics

Agreement to practise by the Registered Healthcare Professional

By signing this PGD you are confirming that you agree to its contents and that you will work within it. PGDs do not remove inherent professional obligations or accountability. It is the responsibility of each healthcare professional to practise only within the bounds of their own competence and professional code of conduct.

Name and address of pharmacy premises / clinic premises to which this PGD relates

Name of healthcare professional	Job title	Registration number	Signature
Valid from date		Expiry date	
25/8/26		31/7/27	

PGD adoption and authorisation by the employer/clinical lead

The employer has ensured that the person using this PGD, has the knowledge and skills to safely provide the service which will encompass the supply or administration of a medication or vaccine.

This section must be signed by the superintendent or clinical lead responsible for this service.

Name of superintendent / clinical lead	Job title & name of organisation	Signature	Date

Name of professional group signatory

Job title & name of organisation

Signature

Date

Signed on behalf of Get Real Health

Name	Qualification	Signature	Date
Nitin Shori	Medical Doctor GMC: 6047293		25/8/2025
Chris Pilkington	Pharmacist GPhC: 2046322		25/8/2025

Change history

Version number	Change details	Date
001	Development & issue of new PGD	25 th June 2025